

A decorative graphic on the left side of the slide consisting of two overlapping parallelograms. The front one is blue and the back one is a light green. They are positioned diagonally, with the blue one partially covering the green one.

Isaiah 40-49

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- The book of Isaiah contains numerous prophecies that seem to have **multiple fulfillments**.
 - One - the people of Isaiah's day or the circumstances of the **next generation**.
 - Another - events in the meridian of time, when Jerusalem was destroyed and her people scattered after the crucifixion.
 - Still another the events attending the second coming of the savior. *Ensign, Jan 1995*
 - There is a time jump, chapters 1-39 = 740-700 bc, to 40+ = 540 bc.
 - Their temple was destroyed,
 - cities have been leveled, and moved into captivity.
 - People losing hope in God.
 - Then chapter 40 hits and things start to turn good.
 - Someone read 40:1, the very first thing said in chap. 40.
 - Someone read chap 40:2.
 - Jerusalem has been punished but now she has received the Lord's hand doubled for all of her sins.
 - Throughout this chap. the Lord pretty much says **I have forgotten your sins** and I will help you move forward.
 - **Major Takeaway:** This isn't just about them in the past this is about us, and everyone else. Even though we might not deserve it, the Lord is giving us **comfort**.

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- The text often switches between speaking as if to a group and an individual,
 - which means that God works with groups the same way he works with us on an individual level.
 - Verse 3: In the past, roads were hard to build and maintain so when he says that he will build a highway for them to walk on...
 - Ex/ To take this into our own lives, God will smooth the way for us,
 - this doesn't mean it will be easy, but there are people there to help us along the way.
 - Ex/ There are messengers like the 12 apostles and helpers like loved ones.
 - Verse 4:(Continues on 3) Says that on the highway the impossible will be made possible with the Lord's help.
 - Verse 8: Switch of topic, comfort to trust.
 - Powerful: We can always trust in what God says.
 - Ex/ In every aspect of the gospel we have to trust in God.
 - Ex/ 41:18 and 43:19.
 - The Lord will provide nourishment and strength along the way.
 - The Lord will be with us with every step.

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- When God invites people to join him he sends them out of their cities where they have all their food, water, and security already provided. And brings them to the wilderness where they are fully dependent on him.
 - Ex/ We see that here because these people have to leave Babylon and go to Jerusalem.
 - Another Ex/ We can relate this to our own lives as well when we have to leave our comfort zone to show that we trust in the lord.
 - The end of any good path in our lives isn't God, the path is him. We aren't going anywhere that matters without him.
 - Sometimes, on the way, the people felt like the Lord isn't there with them,
 - Ex/ 49:14 and 40:27
 - Then a response to these verses: 40:28-31.
 - Means: These people feel like they have been abandoned and ignored but if you wait upon the Lord will give you strength to overcome things.
 - Don't wait upon the Lord by checking your watch and tapping your feet.
 - Be as if a waiter in a restaurant and ask him, how can I serve thee?
 - What do you want me to do next?

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- 40:12-13 and 40:18:
 - A strong example of the power of God in comparison to mankind. How do you build something so grand and glorious as God? His point is that you can't, therefore you should trust in him and put your hope in him and all of these things, not in man made things.
 - A part that got Israel in trouble is idolatry, idol workshop. And the Lord gives repeated warnings about things like this,
 - Ex/ 48:18 - which means that the Lord is preparing the way but the Israelites have to get rid of the things that are holding them back from the lord, like idolatry.
 - 41:22 - The lord then challenges the idols in pretty much saying do something here to show you have any actual power to save.
 - Ex of idolatry: Google, don't look things up to find deep spiritual answers; fast, pray.
 - 43:1-3, challenges will hurt but to overcome them we have to trust in the lord.
 - 49:4-6 , The lord thinks it would be too easy for the Israelites to just get them out of there, the Lord tells the Israelites to spread the gospel.

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- The lord has a wonderful way of turning what look like tragedies into triumphs.
 - 49:13-16, 15: Isaiah takes the most needy relationship between a baby and mother and says that even that will sometimes break down but the love of the Lord will not, the Lord will not forget thee.
 - v16: The Lord says that he can't forget you and that he has engraved you upon the palms of my hands.
 - Even though the Lord is so much more powerful than us, we are still precious to him. ^
 - Close: What did Jesus sacrifice for you?